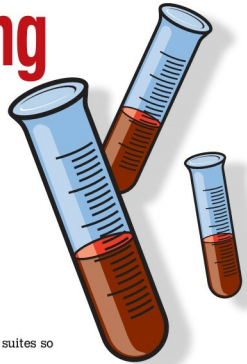


Automate Testing Web Apps with WebTest



WebTest lets developers write XML-based test suites so quickly, it's almost fun!

Virtually everyone uses a browser every time the computer is switched on—the browser has become an integral part of a user's computing experience. Since users can begin using Web-based software with little or no training, it reduces the 'distance' between the user and the developer. However, testing Web-based software to ensure it is bug-free is a real challenge. Tools that automate the testing process make the QA engineer's life easier. It's even better if the test automation tool is easy to learn, and produces high-quality test suites, quickly.

WebTest is an automated Web functional testing tool. It is an open source tool released under the Apache License, version 2.0. The project was founded in 2001, and currently involves four full-time committers. The tool is written in Java, is built using the Apache Ant build system, and is platform-independent.

In this article, we'll take a quick look at how to download, install and start using this tool.

To begin with, here are the prerequisites:

- JDK 1.5.x and higher
- Ant version 1.7.0 or newer (optional)
- WebTest's distribution should contain the necessary parts from Ant 1.7.0, ready to run

- An archive manager utility to unzip the archive

Install and configure

You can download WebTest from <http://webtest.canoo.com/webtest/manual/Downloads.html>. Download the package *build.zip* and extract it in any directory of your choice. The directory in which you extract the package is referred to as *WebTest home*. In this directory, the subdirectory *lib/* contains the Java libraries that comprise the WebTest runtime, and the *bin/* subdirectory contains shell scripts for UNIX and Windows, which start WebTest on the respective OS.

On UNIX-like operating systems, add the *bin/* directory of your *WebTest home* to your *PATH* environment variable. For example, assuming that *WebTest home* is */usr/local/webtest*, add the following line to your *.bashrc* (user-specific Bash init file):

```
export PATH=${PATH}:/usr/local/webtest/bin
```



Tip: Since WebTest is written in Java and is thus platform-independent, it can also run on Windows.